



It is wise to register your brand as your trademark (see pp.212–215), so that rivals cannot imitate it and undermine your business.

Personal branding

Developing a personal brand can also be highly beneficial for freelancers and contractors. It is a reflection of how you present yourself to colleagues and clients. Like a business brand, a personal brand encompasses outward appearance but is also about your behavior—if people are to trust you, your actions must be genuine and consistent.

DEFINING BRAND IDENTITY

French professor of marketing strategy Jean-Noël Kapferer created the Brand Identity Prism in 1996, with six aspects he considered vital to brand identity.

Physique The brand's physical appearance, materials, and qualities, including its packaging and color.

Personality The type of person the brand would be if it were human.

Relationship The bond between the brand and the consumer, which is particularly important for retailers and the service sector.

Culture The building of a cult following, closely allied to the brand's country of origin.

Reflection The outward mirror: the type of person the consumer perceives the brand to be aimed at.

Self-image The inward mirror: how the company perceives its own brand.



Audio-visual elements

Use memorable symbols, phrases, and sounds that resonate with customers.

Brand name

Choose a name that reflects your brand concept; make it both different and memorable (see pp.58–59).

Design and packaging

Pick a style that reflects your image and values. If you are a green business, choose recyclable material.

S strapline

Use a few words to encapsulate what your business is about. Keep it short and snappy.



Communicating your brand identity

Brainstorm how you can best convey your brand to potential customers, perhaps through eye-catching design, a distinctive logo, and an unforgettable slogan. Remember that you may need to communicate your brand across more than one media platform.

Nurturing the relationship

Branding is really about creating a lasting relationship with the customer, (see pp.62–63). People will remain loyal and be preferential to your brand if they can empathize with its concept, personality, and values. Ensure everything you do reinforces this relationship and does nothing to harm it.